Question 3

Inclusive Approach to Software Engineering: a critical evaluation of the class padlet

Common themes. Copilot grouped the [N] padlet posts [1] into four themes (Figure 1): accessibility for disabled users, bias in data and AI, the digital divide (age, income, location) and diversity in development teams. Accessibility was the most frequent, e.g. "[direct quote]" [1]. External evidence supports this: WCAG 2.2 sets testable success criteria because many interfaces still exclude disabled users [3]. The bias theme is also well supported – commercial gender classifiers misclassified darker-skinned women up to 34.7% of the time, against 0.8% for lighter-skinned men [4]. However, one post argued "[contradictory quote]" [1], showing that not every contributor saw inclusion as the developer's responsibility.

Missing and under/over-represented ideas. Accessibility posts were over-represented and mostly about visual impairment, while neurodiversity, LGBTQ+ users, non-English speakers and low-bandwidth users were [rarely / never] mentioned. Few posts cited evidence, and because contributors were computing students of a similar age, the padlet reflects a narrow viewpoint – arguably the same data gap it criticises [5].

Critical use of AI. Copilot was used to theme and visualise the posts [2]. Its first output produced [seven] overlapping themes, so we re-prompted it to merge them into four and list the posts under each. We then checked every post against the padlet: [X] posts were misplaced and [one theme summary was not in any post], so these were corrected (Figure 2). As Copilot cannot verify claims, all supporting evidence was sourced independently.

Overall, the padlet identifies the major inclusion issues but is narrow in perspective and light on evidence, so it is a useful starting point rather than a complete picture.

[INSERT FIGURE 1 HERE: the mind map Copilot produced from the padlet posts. Delete this box text and paste the image (Insert > Picture), sized to fill this box]

Figure 1: *Copilot-generated mind map of padlet themes, checked and corrected by us [1], [2].*

"[most representative padlet post, quoted word-for-word]" [1]

Checking the AI output

[INSERT FIGURE 2: screenshot of your follow-up Copilot prompt(s), or a mini table: Theme | posts per Copilot | posts after our check]

Who is missing from the padlet?

Under- or not represented [tick only those that really are missing]:

- Neurodivergent users (autism, ADHD, dyslexia)
- LGBTQ+ users and non-binary gender data
- Non-English speakers and low-literacy users
- Rural / low-bandwidth / low-cost-device users

Over-represented: accessibility for visually impaired users [confirm]

Evidence: only [X of N] posts cited a source.

References (Question 3)

[Merge these into the group's single References page and renumber so citations run in order across Q1–Q3.]

[1] [Group name / module team], "CO3101 Inclusive approach to software engineering," Padlet, 2026. [Online]. Available: [padlet URL]. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

[2] Microsoft Copilot, "Thematic grouping and mind map of CO3101 padlet posts," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Copilot chat link]. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

[3] World Wide Web Consortium (W3C), "Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2," W3C Recommendation, Oct. 2023. [Online]. Available: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/

[4] J. Buolamwini and T. Gebru, "Gender shades: Intersectional accuracy disparities in commercial gender classification," in *Proc. 1st Conf. Fairness, Accountability and Transparency*, PMLR vol. 81, 2018, pp. 77–91.

[5] C. Criado Perez, *Invisible Women: Exposing Data Bias in a World Designed for Men*. London, U.K.: Chatto & Windus, 2019.

[6] Anthropic Claude, "Drafting structure for CO3101 CW1 Question 3," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Claude chat link]. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

AI use declaration

Microsoft Copilot [2] was used to group padlet posts into themes and produce the mind map in Figure 1; every post was manually checked against the padlet and errors were corrected. Claude [6] was used to help draft the structure and wording of this answer; all quotes, figures and claims were checked by the group. [Edit to match exactly what you did.]